PRELUDE XI

THE ornaments indicate a moderate *tempo* in which a shake will contrast brightly with the prevalent flow of semiquavers. The autographs show in their very discrepancies that Bach was here at special pains to distinguish between two kinds of initial turn in the shakes. The remarkable feature in the case is that they systematically collide with the note preceding them. This is evidently why Bach is so particular about them here. Accordingly, these initial turns are here written out as grace-notes. On the face of it these should be played on the beat, rather slowly and with expressive *appoggiatura*-like emphasis on the first note. But another possibility is that Bach means merely to begin the shake on its main note, and that the object of this notation is to provide a first note that can be tied to the end of the previous passage. This point actually occurs in a remarkable sketch of a suite published in vol. xlv. of the *Bach-Gesellschaft* (pp. 165-166 in four places).

In one autograph of this Prelude Bach has sometimes given the sign for the usual final turn. This may, indeed, be always understood and played where the shake is followed by the diatonic note next above or below it. Where there is a skip, a chromatic progression, or other complication, the final turn is less advisable (see left hand in bars 3 and 9, and the upper trill of the right hand in bar 13). The quaver figures are well suited for a not too dry *staccato*, perhaps with occasional slurs and accents. Note the absence of a final pause, showing that Bach is making a point of the abrupt ending on the last quaver of the bar.

FUGUE XI

THE whole materials of this Fugue are the Subject; a Countersubject flowing out of it, and once actually used by itself (bass of bars 13-16); and a Stretto in the octave at two bars' distance in three parts. The only Episodes are in bars 31-36 and 56-64. The incident of three rising quavers in the bass of Episode 1 is expanded into an emphatic rising scale in Episode 2, and developed thence to the end of the Fugue. This scale-figure thus produces most of the climax in the composition.

The Stretto first appears in two parts, between bars 25-31; and then in three parts, in D minor (led from the top), between bars 36 and 44. After a full close in D minor it is given again in G minor (led from the bass), between bars 46 and 54. While other allusions to the first figure of the Subject (as in bars 35 and 43) add to the cumulative effect, they should not be confused with real entries of the Subject. On the other hand, special attention is demanded by ornamented versions, such as that initiated in the third bar of the Subject during the G minor

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Stretto, and afterwards applied to its first bar in the final entry in bar 65, with its subtle answer in a suggestion of a new and closer stretto in bar 66.

The *tempo* is quietly flowing in quavers decidedly slower than those of the Prelude, but not dragging. The unexpected C♯ in bar 54 shows a kind of detail that must not be hurried over. A *legato* touch is appropriate throughout, but see the final suggestion as to the phrasing of the Subject.

In bars 41-42 a scruple about the unorthodox $\frac{6}{4}$ chord led to the suspending of the treble C♯ into bar 42, so that the following D, C♮ became demisemiquavers between the first and second beat. The correction seems fairly authentic, but is unnecessarily scrupulous.

The sign ~ can, throughout this Fugue, always be read as a full shake with turn, except when it comes on a dotted quaver, where it will stop on the dot, and in bar 55.

The Countersubject should be quite as distinct as the Subject. In the difficult crossing at bar 6 keep the left hand at the edge of the key, and the right hand above and behind. The D may then easily be played by both hands, or by the right alone. The clear inference is that in the Subject the first five quavers should be phrased apart from the following semiquavers (in bar 2, but decidedly not in bar 3). These five quavers are so often disturbed by colliding other parts that there is much to be said for detaching them in a melodious *mezzo-staccato*.